

A380X ATC COM pages and SD mailbox

Datalink with ATC (CPDLC logon, requests, reports, emergency, ATIS) on the MFD ATC COM pages of the FCOM, and the ATC mailbox on the SD

Aircraft	A380X
Where to find it	MFD system menu ATC COM (or the KCCU ATC COM key); the MAILBOX at the bottom of the SD
PR branch	pr/22-a380x-mfd-atccom (stacked on PR 10)
Status	Tested in the sim on 2026-09-27 (ATIS, REQUEST / REPORT / EMERGENCY frames, fixes of the test included); logon to BeyondATC and a MAYDAY sent tested on 2026-09-29 after the datalink connection fix; full CPDLC dialogues with a live ATC network are still to test.
Pictures	Captain MFD and SD in the local browser harness, running the build installed in the sim; the messages come from the harness (no ATC network).

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1. What it is for

The A380 talks to ATC by datalink: the crew logs on to a center, sends requests and reports, receives clearances and answers them, and gets the airport ATIS as text. The FCOM describes the MFD **ATC COM** pages (DSC-46-10-20-30) and the SD **MAILBOX** (DSC-46-10-10-70). They are all built on their FCOM figures and connected to the FBW ATSU, the same datalink system as the A32NX DCDU.

NOTE

The network is chosen in the flyPad: Settings > ATSU / AOC (Hoppie, BeyondATC or SayIntentions). The datalink needs VHF3 in DATA mode on the RMP.

Page (header)	Use
CONNECT	Logon (NOTIFICATION), CONNECTION STATUS with ADS, MAX UPLINK DELAY.
REQUEST	Build a request from frames (climb, direct, offset, weather deviation, speed, clearances...) and send it to the mailbox.
REPORT & MODIFY	Position report, other reports, modify a prepared answer.
MSG RECORD	The record of the closed dialogues.
ATIS	Request and read the ATIS of three airports.
EMER	MAYDAY / PANPAN and the emergency reports.

2. Logging on: CONNECT

1. CONNECT > NOTIFICATION: type the **ATC CENTER** (4 letters) and press **NOTIFY**. The page shows NOTIFYING, then the center in NOTIFIED TO CENTERS (with the time), or NOTIFICATION FAILED.
2. When ATC accepts, CONNECTION STATUS shows the ACTIVE ATC (and the NEXT ATC after a transfer). DISCONNECT ends the connection.

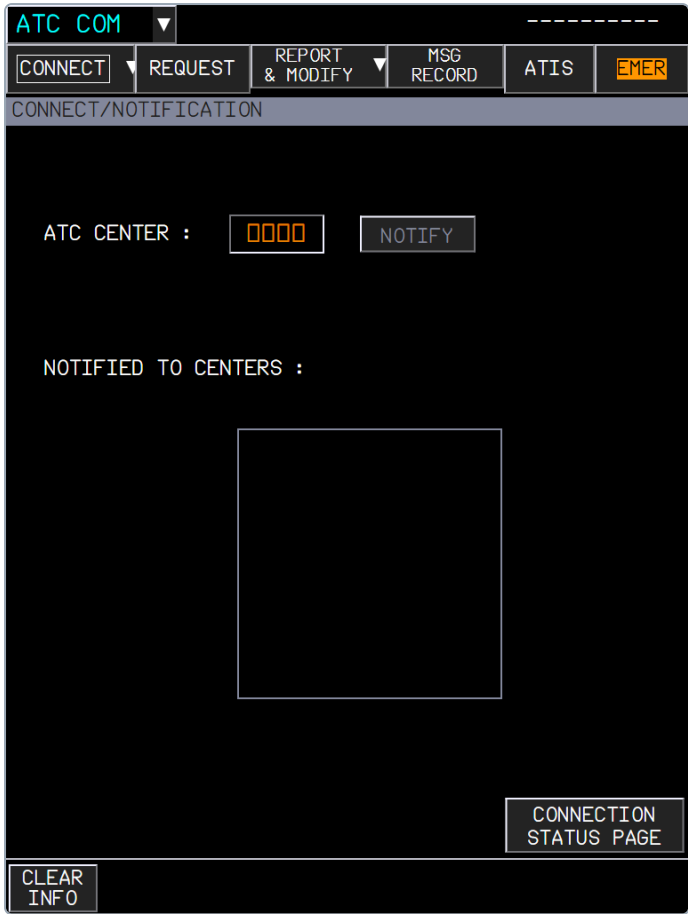


Figure 1. CONNECT / NOTIFICATION.

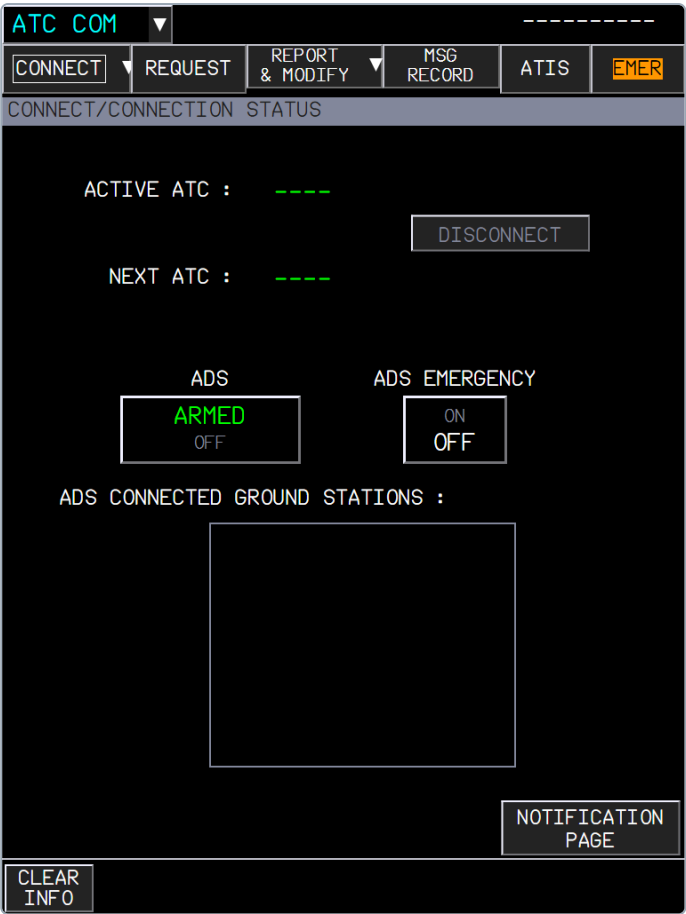


Figure 2. CONNECTION STATUS: active and next ATC, ADS ARMED / OFF, ADS EMERGENCY.

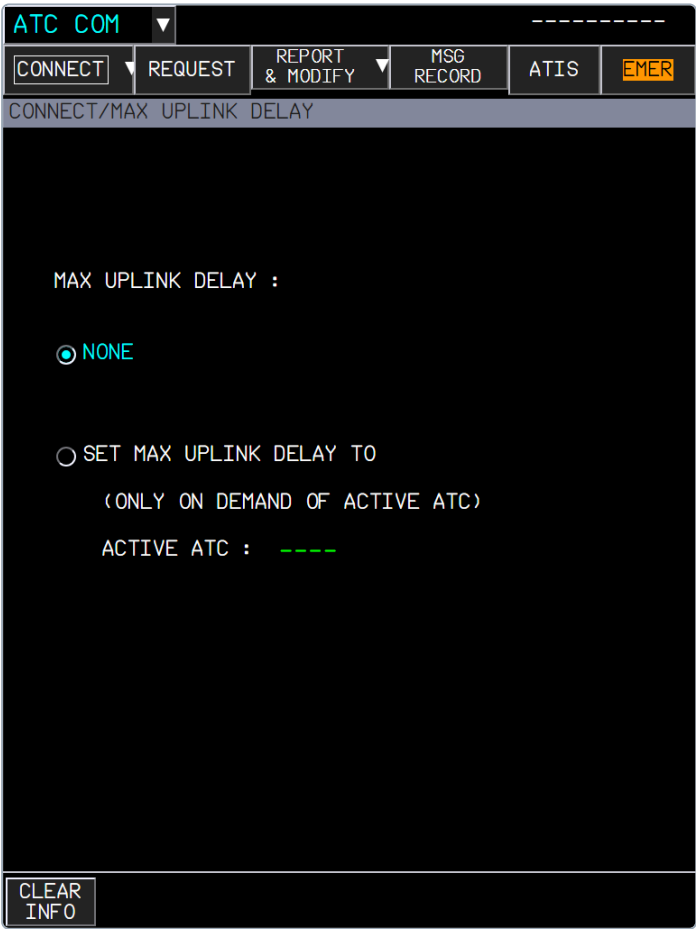


Figure 3. MAX UPLINK DELAY: NONE, or a delay set on the demand of the active ATC.

3. Asking ATC: REQUEST

1. Open the menus on the right (VERTICAL, LATERAL, SPEED, CLEARANCE, WHEN CAN WE EXPECT, OTHER) and pick the frames you need; up to 5 frames, each with its fields.
2. Fill the fields (FCOM entry formats; amber boxes are mandatory). ADD TEXT adds free text. The bin deletes a frame.
3. Press **XFR TO MAILBOX**: the request goes to the SD mailbox, where you **SEND** it.

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

REQUEST

REQUEST DIR TO

TADEX

REQUEST CLB TO

FL360

AT

REQUEST OFFSET

0000

AT

REQUEST DEVIATION 20NM LEFT

DUE TO WEATHER

VERTICAL

LATERAL

SPEED

CLEARANCE

WHEN CAN WE EXPECT

OTHER

ADD TEXT

CANCEL

XFR TO MAILBOX

CLEAR INFO

Figure 4. A request of 5 frames: DIR TO TADEx, CLB TO FL360, OFFSET (amber: to fill), free text, DUE TO WEATHER.

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

REQUEST

DEPARTURE ARPT

0000

DESTINATION

0000

 GATE

A/C TYPE

A388

 ATIS CODE

0

VERTICAL

LATERAL

SPEED

CLEARANCE

WHEN CAN WE EXPECT

OTHER

ADD TEXT

CANCEL

XFR TO MAILBOX

CLEAR INFO

Figure 5. CLEARANCE > DEPARTURE: the departure clearance request (DCL): departure airport, destination, gate, aircraft type, ATIS code.

4. Reports: REPORT & MODIFY

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

REPORT/AUTO & MANUAL POSITION

AUTO POSITION REPORT

ON
OFF

OVHD	MIPAK	UTC 0946 Z	ALT 32000 FT
PPOS	TAVUN	1005 Z	32000 FT
TO	PUT	1022 Z	
NEXT	DALAN		

CAS	GROUND	VERTICAL
SPEED 310 KT	320 KT	0 FT/MIN
HEADING 135 °T	TRACK 132 °T	

WIND -----	SAT -40 C
ICING TRACE	TURBULENCE LIGHT

ETA DEST 1133 Z	ENDURANCE 4 H30 MIN
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☐DEVIATING☐CLIMBING TO☐DESCENDING TO

ERASE
ALL FIELDS

REFRESH
DATA

ADD
FREETEXT

XFR
TO MAILBOX

CLEAR
INFO

Figure 6. AUTO & MANUAL POSITION: the position report filled by the FMS (overhead, present position, to, next, times, levels, speeds, wind, SAT, ETA, endurance); AUTO POSITION REPORT ON sends it at each reporting point.

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

REPORT/OTHER REPORTS

BACK ON ROUTE

BACK
ON ROUTE

PASSING
POSITION

LEAVING
ALTITUDE

LEVEL

REACHING
ALTITUDE

REACHING
BLOCK

ADD
FREETEXT

CANCEL

XFR
TO MAILBOX

CLEAR
INFO

Figure 7. OTHER REPORTS: back on route, passing position, leaving / reaching altitude, level, reaching block, free text.

ATC COM

CONNECT

REQUEST

REPORT & MODIFY

MSG RECORD

ATIS

EMER

REPORT/MODIFY

PRESENT ALTITUDE 12500 FT

CANCEL

ADD FREETEXT

XFR TO MAILBOX

CLEAR INFO

NO FMS DATA

Figure 8. MODIFY: a prepared answer (here PRESENT ALTITUDE 12500 FT) that the crew can change before sending.

5. The SD MAILBOX

Every message to and from ATC goes through the mailbox at the bottom of the SD. It shows the active ATC, the ADS status, the message and the answer buttons the message expects.

SAT

XX °C

10:24: 00 GPS

GWCG

XX %

XX KG

FOB

XX KG

ACTIVE ATC : LFBO

ADS OFF

RECALL

Figure 9. Mailbox without a message: ACTIVE ATC LFBO, ADS OFF.

SAT XX °C		10:24: 00 GPS	GW XX KG GWCG XX % FOB XX KG	
 MSG 1/3  RECALL	1425Z FROM KZAK CTL OPEN CLIMB TO REACH FL340 BY BERGI		WILCO STANDBY UNABLE PRINT	

Figure 10. An uplink: CLIMB TO REACH FL340 BY BERGI, OPEN, with WILCO / STANDBY / UNABLE. MSG 1/3: three messages are waiting.

SAT XX °C		10:24: 00 GPS	GW XX KG GWCG XX % FOB XX KG	
 RECALL	TO KZAK CTL REQUEST DEVIATION 20NM LEFT OF ROUTE DUE TO CB AHEAD WILL ADVISE WHEN CLEAR OF WEATHER THANKS		SEND CANCEL PRINT	

Figure 11. A request ready to go: SEND or CANCEL.

The message expects	Buttons
WILCO / UNABLE (a clearance)	WILCO, STANDBY, UNABLE
AFFIRM / NEGATIVE (a question)	AFFIRM, STANDBY, NEGATIVE
ROGER (information)	ROGER
A departure or oceanic clearance	ACK / REFUSE

UNABLE and NEGATIVE can add a reason (DUE TO WEATHER, A/C PERFORMANCE, TURBULENCE) and free text; MODIFY opens the answer on the MFD. The message colours follow the FCOM status legend.

6. MSG RECORD and ATIS

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

MSG RECORD/LIST

1250ZFROM LFBO CTL
CLIMB TO FL380

1247ZFROM LFBO CTL
WILCO

1246ZFROM LFBO CTL
ROGER

1245ZFROM LFBO CTL
UNABLE

1244ZFROM LFBO CTL
NEGATIVE

1243ZFROM LFBO CTL
AFFIRM

1242ZFROM LFBO CTL
STANDBY

1241ZFROM LFBO CTL
WILCO

ERASE ALL

PRINT ALL

CLEAR INFO

Figure 12. MSG RECORD: the closed dialogues with their time and the answer given; ZOOM shows one in full; ERASE ALL, PRINT ALL.

ATC COM

CONNECTREQUESTREPORT & MODIFYMSG RECORDATISEMER

ATIS/LIST

LFBODEPR 1145Z

LFBO DEP ATIS R 1145Z EXP ARR RWY 32R AND 21L /DEP /SID 5 B. 5 P WIND CALM VIS 3500 M - CB FEW 500 FT BKN 26000 FT /

LFPOARR

SEND REQUEST
AUTO UPDATE

LFPGARRP 1200Z

LFPG ARR ATIS P 1200Z ATIS INFO ARR/DEP APCH ILS APCH LDG 27L AND 26L / RWY 26 L WET TL 40 BIRD HAZARD AFTER VACATING RWY 26L HOLD SHORT OF RWY 26R TKOF 27L AND 26R SID 8A 8B 8Y 8Z QNH 1013 TEMP 12 DEWPOINT 8

SEND AGAIN

OPTIONS

PRINT ALL

UPDATE ALL

CLEAR INFO

Figure 13. ATIS: three request areas (departure, arrival, alternate, following the FMS airports), each with its ATIS text, AUTO UPDATE, and SEND REQUEST / SEND AGAIN.

ATC COM

CONNECT

REQUEST

REPORT
& MODIFY

MSG
RECORD

ATIS

EMER

ATIS/RECEIVED

LFB0 DEP R 1145Z
LFB0 DEP ATIS R 1145Z EXP ARR RWY 32R AND
21L /DEP /SID 5 B. 5 P WIND CALM VIS 3500 M
- CB FEW 500 FT BKN 26000 FT /

RETURN
TO LIST

CLEAR
INFO

Figure 14. ATIS RECEIVED: the full text of an ATIS, RETURN TO LIST.

7. Emergency: EMER

The screenshot shows the 'EMERGENCY' interface within the 'ATC COM' system. At the top, there's a header bar with 'ATC COM' and a dropdown arrow. Below this is a navigation bar with buttons: 'CONNECT', 'REQUEST', 'REPORT & MODIFY', 'MSG RECORD', 'ATIS', and 'EMER' (highlighted in orange). The main area has an orange title bar labeled 'EMERGENCY'. Below the title bar, there's a section for 'ADS EMERGENCY' with 'ON' and 'OFF' buttons. The central part of the screen displays 'MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY' next to a trash icon. To the right of this, there's a vertical list of buttons: 'MAYDAY', 'PANPAN', 'CANCEL EMER', 'CLIMBING TO', 'DESCENDING TO', 'DIVERTING/VIA', 'OFFSETTING', 'REQUEST VOICE CONTACT', 'ENDURANCE & SOULS', and 'ADD FREETEXT'. At the bottom, there are three buttons: 'CANCEL', 'XFR TO MAILBOX', and 'CLEAR INFO'.

Figure 15. EMERGENCY (orange title): MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY frame, PANPAN, CANCEL EMER and the emergency reports (climbing / descending to, diverting, offsetting, voice contact, endurance and souls). MAYDAY also switches the ADS to EMERGENCY.

8. Getting connected: the flight number, and messages that cannot be sent

The ATC COM pages send and receive through the aircraft datalink, which connects with the flight number of the active flight plan (FMS INIT, FLT NBR). It must be your callsign on the network (Hoppie, BeyondATC or SayIntentions: the one set in the flyPad, Settings > ATSU / AOC).

- The flight number connects the datalink however it gets there: typed on the INIT page, from the company flight plan (SimBrief), from an activated secondary flight plan, or already there when you reload the flight.
- If the connection is refused, or the datalink does not answer, the FMS message area shows **FMS DATALINK NOT AVAIL** (white). It goes away by itself once connected; typing the flight number again tries again.
- A message sent from the mailbox with no ATC center connected (no logon done, or the center logged you off) shows **SEND FAILED** instead of nothing.

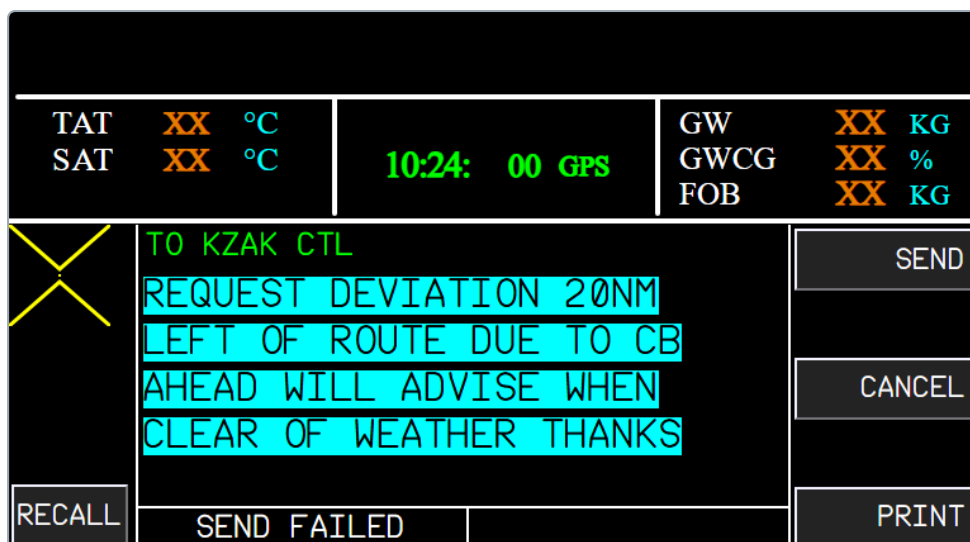


Figure 16. SEND FAILED under a message the mailbox could not send (no active ATC center).

NOTE

With BeyondATC: log on to the center shown in its Frequencies tab (e.g. RJJJ), above FL145. BeyondATC does not handle MAYDAY or PAN PAN by datalink: it answers NO MESSAGE HANDLING AVAILABLE FOR THIS REQUEST. Declare an emergency by voice with it.

9. What to expect

Situation	What you should see
NOTIFY with no network set	NOTIFICATION FAILED.
Request with an empty mandatory field	XFR TO MAILBOX stays greyed.
Uplink received	Mailbox message with its answer buttons.
Answer sent	The dialogue closes and goes to MSG RECORD.
ATIS requested	The text appears in its area; a newer version replaces it (AUTO UPDATE).
MAYDAY sent	ADS EMERGENCY ON.

10. Limitations and why

Limitation	Why	What to do
Needs an online datalink network.	ATC messages come from Hoppie, BeyondATC or SayIntentions through the flyPad ATSU settings.	Set the network in the flyPad.
No real ADS contracts.	The ATSU networks do not handle ADS-C; ADS ARMED / EMERGENCY is shown locally.	-
MSG RECORD and mailbox PRINT say PRINTER NOT AVAIL.	Printing needs the pedestal printer, which has no PR yet.	-
CPDLC dialogues with a live network are not tested yet.	Only the harness messages and the ATIS were checked in the sim.	Report any wrong answer element.